

# LATEEF ADETUNJI ADELEKE

✉ ladeleke@ur.rochester.edu 📍 515 Lattimore Hall, Rochester, NY. 🔗 LinkedIn 🔗 lateefadeleke.github.io

## RESEARCH INTEREST

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Language Description and Documentation, Speech Technology, Natural Language Processing

## EDUCATION

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**PhD in Linguistics** 2023 – present

*University of Rochester*

**Advisor:** Nadine Grimm

**QP1: Negation-Conditioned Asymmetries in Uhami.**

Committee Members: Nadine Grimm, Asia Pietraszko, Joyce McDonough, Hannah Sande.

**QP2: Style-Stratified Evaluation of Cross-Lingual ASR.**

Committee Members: Agatha Downey and Nadine Grimm.

**Master's Degree in Linguistics (Awarded upon PhD candidacy)** 2026

*University of Rochester*

**Bachelor of Arts in Linguistics (First Class Honors)** 2015 – 2019

*Adekunle Ajasin University, Akungba-Akoko.*

**Advisor:** Simeon Olaogun

## GRANTS/AWARDS

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**Endangered Languages Documentation Programme- IGS1048 (€91,267)** 🔗 2025 – 2028

*Project: Documentation of Uneme Indigenous Iron Technology.*

**2026 NLDSTC Indigenous NLP Excellence Award** 2026

*Nigerian Languages Data and Sci-Tech Conference*

**Donald M. and Janet C. Barnard Fellowship (\$3000)** 🔗 2026

*Recognizes outstanding achievement for one graduate student in engineering or natural science disciplines.*

**Award for Nigeria's Exceptional Fresh Graduates, i-Scholar Initiative** 🔗 2022

*Covered costs for standardized tests (GRE and TOEFL), and graduate school application fees.*

**Vice Chancellor's Prize for Overall Best Graduating Student (#150,000)** 🔗 2021

*Adekunle Ajasin University, Akungba-Akoko, Ondo State (Nigeria).*

**Clement Bamiduro's Prize for Overall Best Graduating Student (#100,000)** 🔗 2021

*Adekunle Ajasin University.*

**Faculty Prize for Best Graduating Student in the Faculty of Arts. (#100,000)** 🔗 2021

*Adekunle Ajasin University, Akungba-Akoko, Ondo State (Nigeria).*

**Dare Akande Vanguard Scholarship.** 2019

*Tuition support for exceptional undergraduate students from Okeogun.*

**NALLS Tutor of the Year** 🔗 2019

*National Association of Linguistics and Languages Students Association (NALLS), Adekunle Ajasin University.*

**Best Student in Okeogun** 2019

*Progressive Movement of Okeogun.*

**Winner, Fitrah Review Competition, Poetry Category** 🔗 2019

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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### **MCFG\_Parser: A Python Package for Parsing Natural Languages with Multiple Context-Free Grammars (MCFGs)**

2024

*Project: Developed a Python package that implements an agenda-based parser to efficiently handle complex syntactic structures, including discontinuous categories in human language.*

Advisor: Aaron White

### **Collaborator, Grammar and Variation Lab, University of Rochester**

2023 – present

*Ongoing Research: Encoding of Tense, Aspect, and Polarity in West African Languages.*

Advisor: Nadine Grimm

### **Collaborator, Science in Yoruba**

2021 – present

*Ongoing Project: Building an Online Archive to Promote STEM Education in Yoruba, and Translating STEM content into Yoruba for secondary school students.*

Director: Taofeek Adebayo

### **FIELD EXPERIENCE**

- Conducted fieldworks on Uneme in Ekpedo, Edo state, Nigeria.
- Uhami (Edoid): Conducted fieldworks in Isua Akoko, Ondo state, Nigeria.
- Igasi (Benue-Congo, Nigeria): Conducted fieldwork on Igasi, Ondo state, Nigeria.

### **LAB AFFILIATIONS**

- Member, Grammar and Variation Lab, University of Rochester
- Member, Fieldsyntax Lab, University of Rochester

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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### **Teaching Assistant, Linguistics Department, University of Rochester**

2025

Course: Language and Culture

### **Teaching Assistant, Linguistics Department, University of Rochester**

2025

Course: Linguistic Analysis

### **Tutor, National Association of Linguistics and Languages Students, AAUA**

2016 – 2019

Courses: Phonetics, Phonology and Syntax

### **Tutor, Faculty of Arts Student Association (FASA), Adekunle Ajasin University.**

2016 – 2019

Courses: First year students' courses on communication in English (GST111 & GST122) and Philosophy, Logic, and Human Existence (LIN112)

## PUBLICATIONS

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Chen, Fei-Yueh, Adeleke, Lateef, & C. M. Downey (2026). Linguistically informed evaluation of multilingual ASR for African languages. In *Proceedings of the 7th Workshop on African Natural Language Processing (AfricaNLP 2026), EACL 2026, Rabat, Morocco, 149–162. ACL.*

Adeleke, Lateef. & Olaogun, Simeon. (2025) NPI-Licensing: The case of N-kankan in Yoruba. *Ekiti Journal of Language, Literature and Culture* 

Olaogun, Simeon. & Adeleke, Lateef. (2022) A Pragmatic Analysis of Questions in Efunroye Tinubu. *Language Review An International Journal of Linguistics.* 181-184 

Simeon, Olaogun & Adeleke, Lateef (2022) Pragmatic Functions of Rhetorical Questions in Efunroye Tinubu. *Journal of Yoruba Studies Association of Nigeria* -222-235 

## PRESENTATIONS

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Adeleke, L. 2026. Reflexes of Movement in Uhami, ACAL 57, University at Buffalo

Adeleke, L. 2026. Polarity-conditioned Asymmetries in Uneme, ACAL 57, University at Buffalo

2026

Linguistically Informed Evaluation of Multilingual ASR for African Languages, AfricaNLP Workshop at EACL 2026, Rabat, Morocco.

2026

Adeleke, L. 2026. "Reflexes of Movement in Uneme" at the 55th Colloquium on African Languages and Linguistics, Leiden

Adeleke, L.A. 2025. "The Morphosyntax of Tense in Uhami". Presented at the Field Syntax Lab, Department of Linguistics, University of Rochester.

Adeleke, L.A. 2025. "The Morphosyntax of Tense in Uhami". Talk at the 56th Association of Contemporary African Linguistics (ACAL, 56) Conference. University of Minnesota Twin Cities.

Adeleke, L.A. 2025. "Tense and Aspect in Uhami". Presented at the Phz Lab, Department of Linguistics, University of Rochester.

Adeleke, L.A. 2025. "Negation in Uhami". Presented at the Field Syntax Lab, Department of Linguistics, University of Rochester.

Adeleke, L. "Pragmatic Functions of Rhetorical Questions in Efunroye Tinubu." 2nd National Universities Linguistics Students' Annual Conference, University of Lagos.

05/2025

05/2025

03/2025

02/2025

2019

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND CERTIFICATIONS

Language Documentation and Archiving Training, Berlin, Germany

Summer School in Language Science and Technology, Warsaw, Poland

Introduction to Programming with python

NLP- Natural Language Processing with Python

The Python Programming

Participated in the 2025 ELDP Training by the Endangered Languages Documentation Programme.

Completed courses in Phonetics and Speech Technology and Natural Language Processing, earning 3.5 ECTS

Via edu

Via Udemy

Via Udemy

06/2025

2024

2024

2024

2022

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Editor-in-Chief

Office Assistant, Vice-Chancellor's office, Obafemi Awolowo University

Dailyinsiderng

02/2023 – 08/2023

01/2022 – 11/2022

LEADERSHIP RESPONSIBILITIES

Team Lead, Daily Insider

General Secretary, Okeogun People's Award

Financial Secretary

Student Ambassador

Progressive Movement of Okeogun

Muslim Corpers Association of Nigeria

Poets in Nigeria Initiative

2023

2021 – 08/2023

2021 – 2022

2018 – 2019

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Member, Organizing Committee, Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT34), University of Rochester.

Member, Association of Contemporary African Linguistics

Member, Association for Computational Linguistics

Member, Linguistic Society of America

2024

2023 – present

2026 – Present

2025 – Present

## **SKILLS**

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### **TECHNICAL SKILLS**

Programming: Python.

Annotation: ELAN, FLex, Praat.

Typesetting: LaTeX, Word, Excel, PowerPoint.

Corpus Tools: Antconc, Search Engine.

### **LANGUAGE SKILLS**

Yoruba: Native Speaker.

English: Bilingual Proficiency.

Nigerian Pidgin: Native Speaker.